Documentation

Keep a project's metadata trustworthy at a volume no human reviews by hand

dbt docs The description field and the site it compiles into

`description: "..."`	dbt's own doc primitive
`dbt docs generate`	From manifest + catalog
`dbt docs serve`	Hosts it locally

The dbt Catalog What's actually sitting behind the generated site

`Lineage graph`	Model-to-model dependencies
`Test results`	Pass/fail per model
`Source freshness`	Last loaded, per source

Tags and meta Drive selection and carry ownership, same config block

```
tags: ['finance', 'daily']
meta:
  owner: finance-team
```

`dbt build --select tag:finance`	Only that tag

Doc blocks One description written once, referenced everywhere it's needed

```
{% docs order_total %}
The order's total, after discounts.
{% enddocs %}
```

```
description: "{{ doc('order_total') }}"
```

Reference it

A good vs. a useless description Answer the grain and when to use this

`"The order's total amount"`	Useless, restates the name
`"Order total after discount, before tax, USD"`	Useful: grain + when to use this over a similar column

YAML management One file per model, so two edits never collide

`dbt-osmosis yaml refactor`	Organize + cascade
`dbt-osmosis yaml document`	Documentation only
`dbt-osmosis workbench`	Streamlit, live compile
`Spot-check AI drafts`	Not equal scrutiny on all 200

Ask consumers directly Make documentation a group effort, not a solo chore

`"What columns and descriptions do you need for this dashboard?"`	Ask before you build the pipeline

Semantic Layer One metric, defined once, same number everywhere — dbt platform

```
metrics:
  - name: revenue
    label: "Revenue"
    type: simple
    type_params:
      measure: order_total
```

`One API, every BI tool`	Human docs != AI context
`Query it from any BI tool`	Same number, everywhere